



Sanjeev Keskar with family

what value you are bringing to your employer that counts.”

He gives hundred percent credit to his parents for the kind of decision-making ability he has been able to develop over time. “When you make a decision, you have the responsibility to make sure that it is correct. This was taught to me from my childhood. Even if you make a wrong decision, you have to make sure it is not repeated again,” says Keskar.

The best decision that he has taken so far is joining the semiconductor industry and moving to Bangalore for the same. He says that many Maharashtrians do not want to move out of the home state to pursue careers, but he took this decision and has always been thankful for the same.

The big decision: Moving to Bangalore

The biggest decision that Keskar thinks that changed his life for good is the one where he decided to move to Bangalore in 1996. Already into the semiconductors and electronics components arena for more than five years, Keskar was working with Max India as regional manager for sales and was handling distribution sales for Motorola and

AMD in the western region of India. It was then that Keskar was interviewed for the post of distribution manager at an America based organisation named National Semiconductor.

“All my friends and family questioned my decision as I was living in my own home in Maharashtra. They were of the view that moving to Bangalore was not a good decision at all. I was sure of shifting as Bangalore was the upcoming IT city of India, and I could not think of a better organisation to work with than National Semiconductor at that moment,” explains Keskar.

Money was also a big motivation factor to join National Semiconductor for Keskar along with an opportunity to work for a global MNC.

Then came another big decision and opportunity knocking at the door of Keskar. He was selected by AMD to lead sales operations in India. Keskar feels he got the opportunity because of the work experience he had gained from working at previous organisations.

“I feel lucky that every five years opportunities came knocking at my door and all I had to do was make a decision. AMD was a small team of three people in India when I joined

them to lead India operations as first country manager.

“I started AMD when their market share was only 2% as per IDC report then. Joining AMD was a huge challenge, but I am very happy with the way my association turned out with AMD. I was travelling 25 days every month while working with AMD. When I left AMD after four years, the company had 20% market share in India region as per MAIT report and teams sitting across seventeen cities in India, and out of top ten OEMs, eight were offering products with AMD processors,” says Keskar proudly.

It is interesting to note here that Keskar comes from a period where people were afraid to change jobs. Individuals would spend their whole life with just one company. “The reason I kept changing jobs every four-five year was influenced by the opportunity to experience new domains and never getting too comfortable,” says Keskar.

Asked if he was afraid to change jobs he answers, “I never changed jobs for money. The reason I changed jobs every four or five years is because of the learnings attached with these jobs and for taking up new challenges.”

He explains, “I refused taking jobs with companies that were already established because I was sure that I would not be able to do any real value-add to such organisations. It would not be wrong to say that I was attracted to working for startups at that time.”

The IESA chairman

Circling back to his prowess in communication and networking skills, Keskar admits that these were the abilities that helped him become the chairman of IESA. As a matter of fact, Keskar was already on the council of IESA and had become vice-chairman before becoming the chair of IESA.

“I was MD of PMC Sierra’s sales operations when I contested for the post of IESA chairman and became the same,” says Keskar. However, what really helped Keskar in the journey was his association with IESA since his AMD and Freescale Semiconductor days. He was an active contributor to IESA reports, and also an active member at meetings chaired by IESA.

Keskar is proud of the friends that he has made all along the journey. He